How to edit videos with Claude: every effect from my video (1)

🎨 The prompts below include the exact styling I used in my video: fonts, colours, sizes and timing. Swap any of it for your own style.

Setup

Install Claude Code, then paste this:

```
Set me up to edit videos with you. Install Remotion, FFmpeg, Whisper (with word-level timestamps) and yt-dlp. Check each one runs.
```

For anything behind your head you need a person cutout. On a Mac it's built in: tell Claude to use Apple Vision person segmentation. On Windows or Linux, run `pip install rembg`.

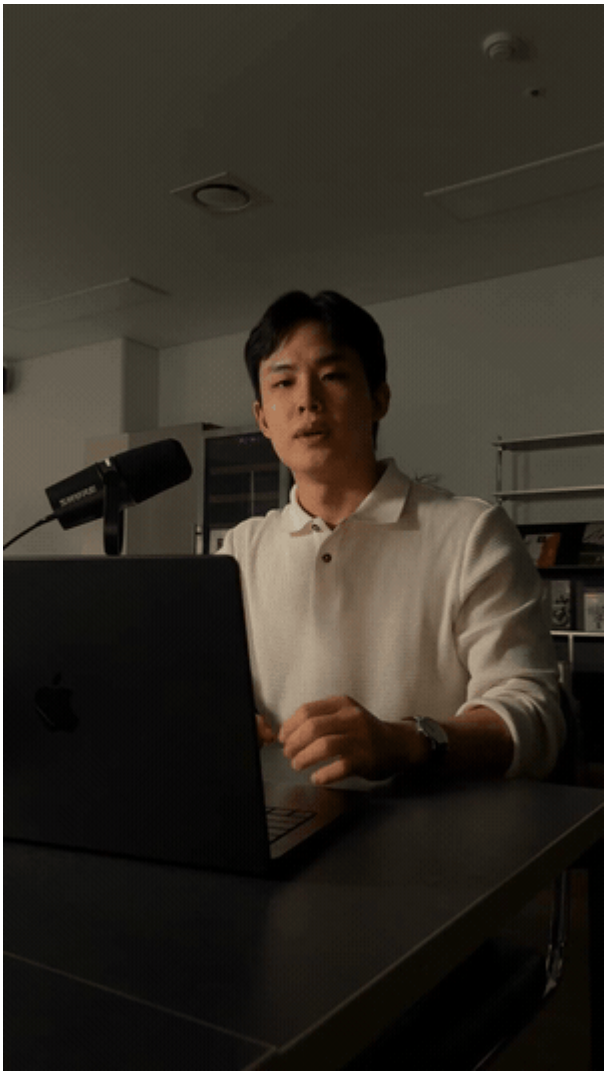
1. Storyboard first



Before Claude edits anything, have it write a storyboard, so you both agree on what the video looks like first.

```
Before you touch the footage, write a storyboard as a table: one row per beat with the time, my exact words, what's on screen, and the tool. Don't render anything until I ap prove it.
```

2. Text behind your head



```
Cut me out with person segmentation. In Remotion, put the title "Text behind / your he
ad" on two lines between the footage and my cutout, so my head covers part of the lett
ers. Font: Geist Pixel Square, 150 px, #F4F4F2, centred at 20% and 27% of the frame he
ight. Each line fades up over 12 frames (ease-out cubic, rising 2% of the frame), the
second 4 frames after the first.
```

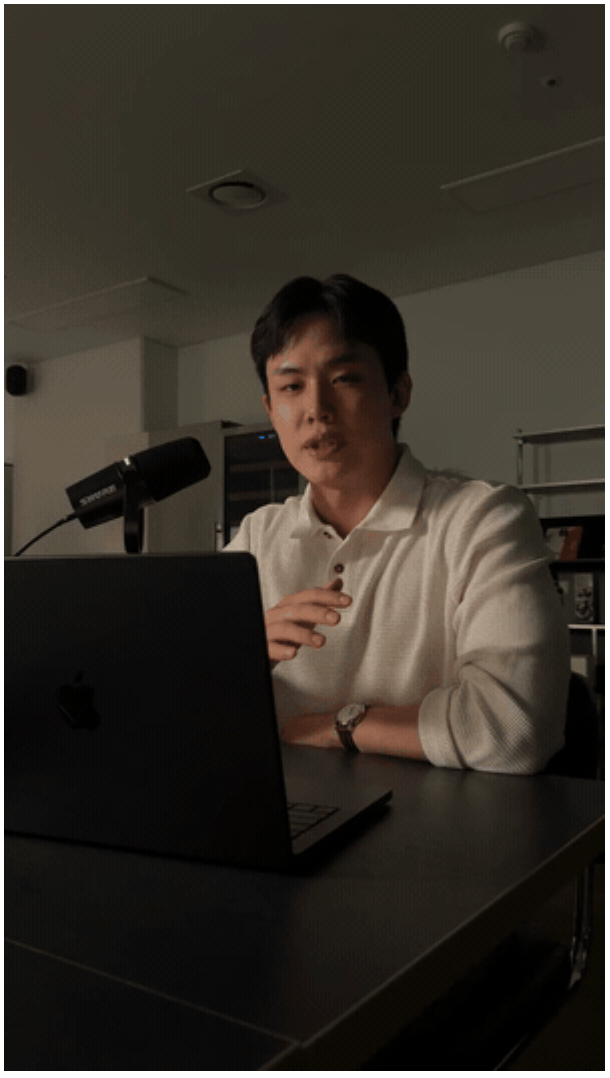
3. Captions




```
Transcribe my clip with Whisper, word-level timestamps. Caption it in Remotion: Helvet
ica Neue Bold, 64 px, white, soft shadow, centred at 61.5% of the frame height. Up to
3 words at a time. The word being spoken sits on a coral (#D97757) box with 8 px round
ed corners; the others have no box. Each chunk cuts on exactly when its first word is
spoken.
```

Make it better: don't put a coloured box behind every caption. Highlight only the word being spoken.

4. Tool labels



When I name a tool, its logo appears and the name slides out of it.

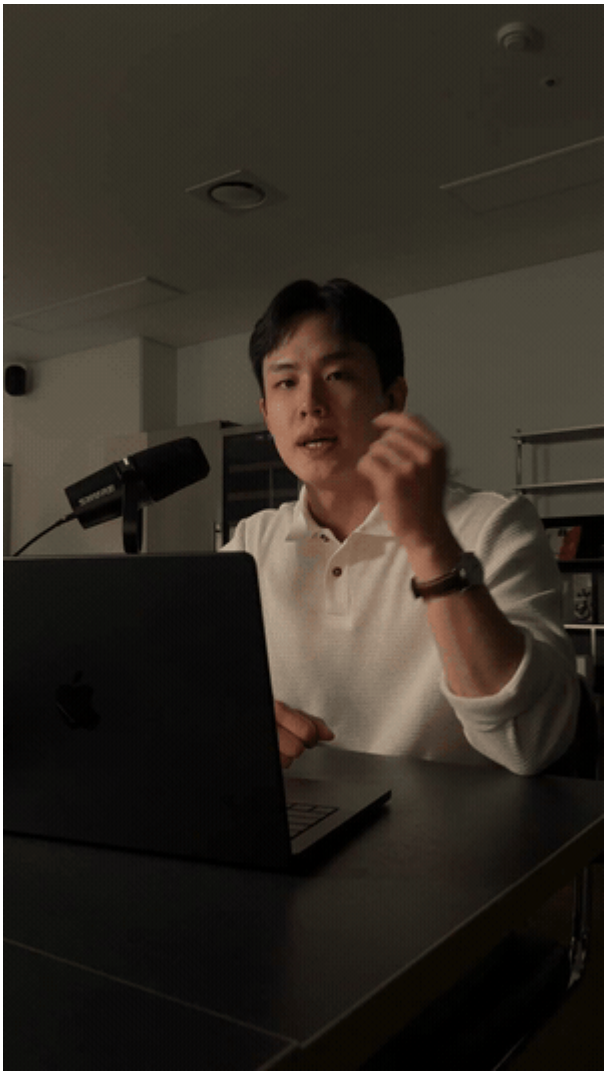
```
When I say a tool's name, show its logo (110 px, rounded corners) at 61.5% of the fram
e height. It fades up over 12 frames (ease-out cubic). Then it slides left while the n
ame (bold white, 92 px tall) slides out from behind it to the right, over 12 frames, s
o logo and name end up centred together.
```

5. Repo cards



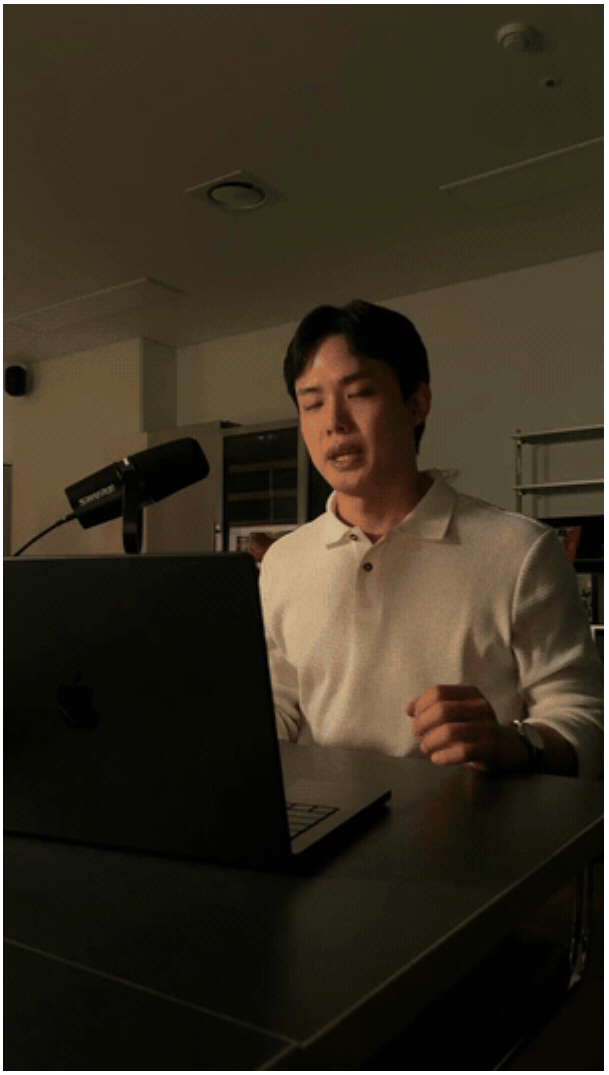
```
When I mention an open-source tool, show its GitHub repo card at the top of the frame:
85% of the frame width, fading up over 12 frames (ease-out cubic, rising 2% of the fra
me). Build the card to look like GitHub's dark theme: owner/name, Public badge, descri
ption, stars and forks.
```

6. Prompt bar



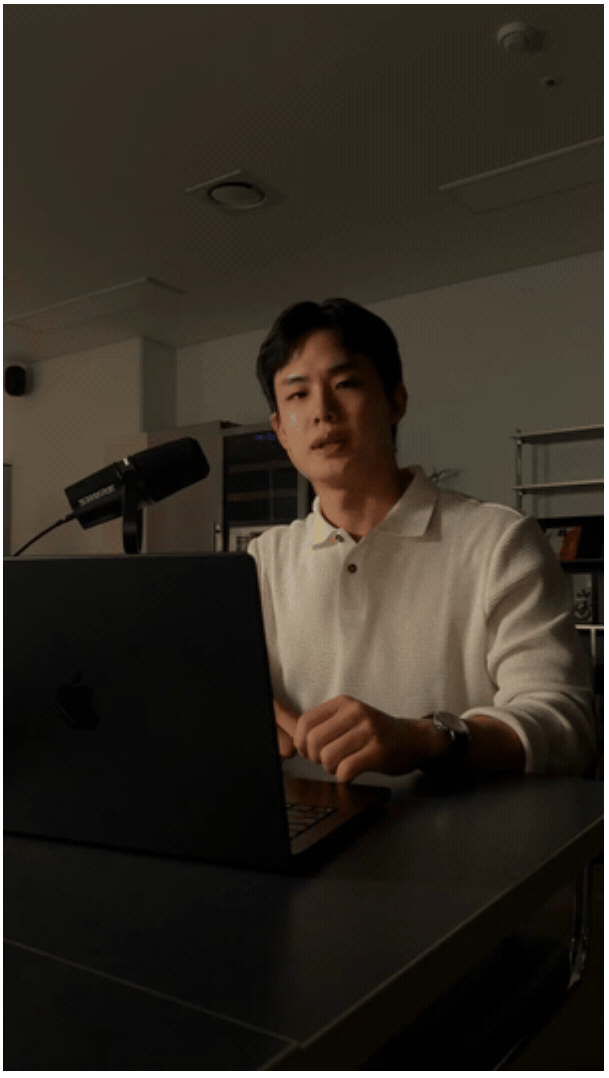
```
Draw a prompt bar as a vector graphic in Remotion: a dark rounded bar (#2B2B2B, fully
rounded ends) with my prompt typing in, white Inter text, and a coral (#D97757) send b
utton with an up arrow. Place it at 22.5% of the frame height, 92.6% of the frame wid
e. Make it a reusable component so every prompt in the video looks the same.
```

7. Colour change with a slider



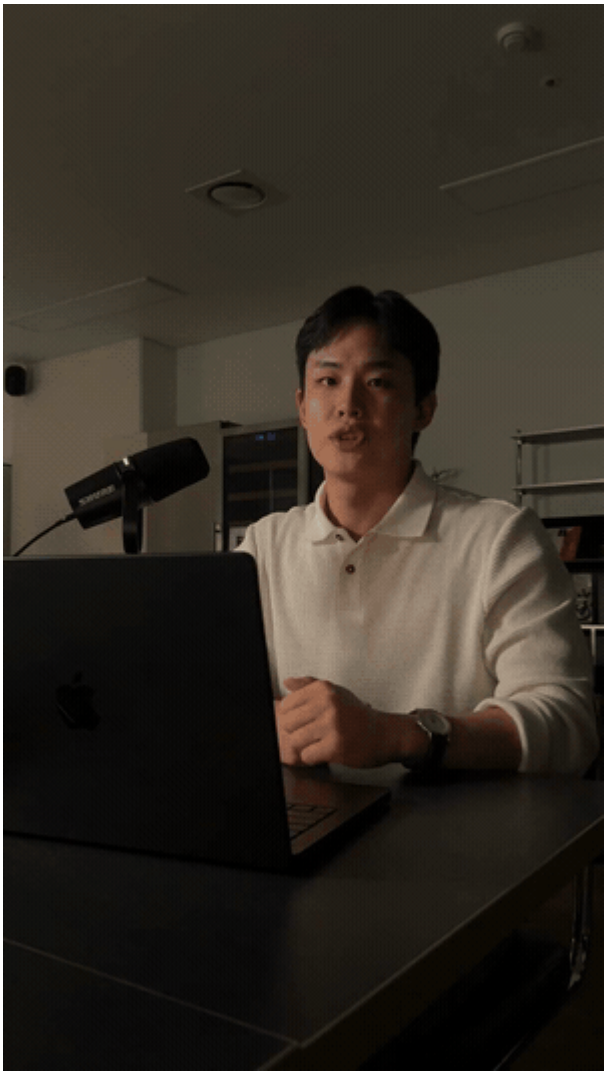
```
Make a warm version of my clip with FFmpeg: colorchannelmixer=rr=1.17:gg=1.10:bb=1.03,
eq=saturation=1.12. In Remotion, start on the warm version, then wipe it off with a th
in white vertical line moving right to left over 30 frames (ease-in-out cubic).
```

8. Magazine cover



```
Turn this shot into a magazine cover with my person cutout: a thin gold frame, a cream
serif masthead "CLAUDE" behind my head, cover lines in the top corners and a barcode o
n the left. The masthead goes behind me, everything else in front. Bring each element
in on a stressed word.
```

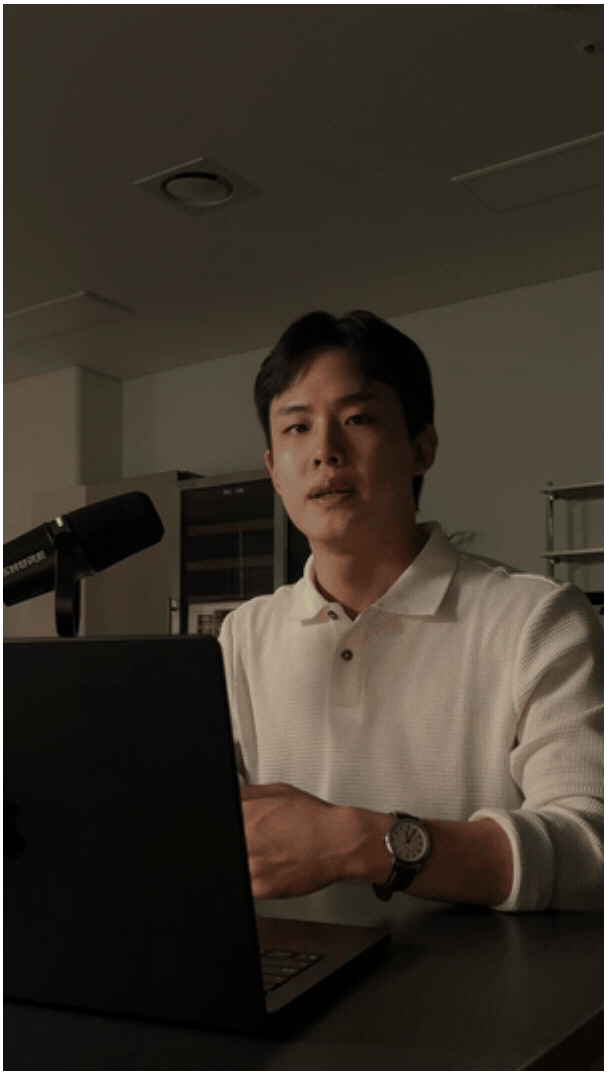
9. Real screenshots



```
Fade up this screenshot of my editor timeline above my head: 90% of the frame wide, ro
unded corners, soft shadow, 12 frames (ease-out cubic).
```

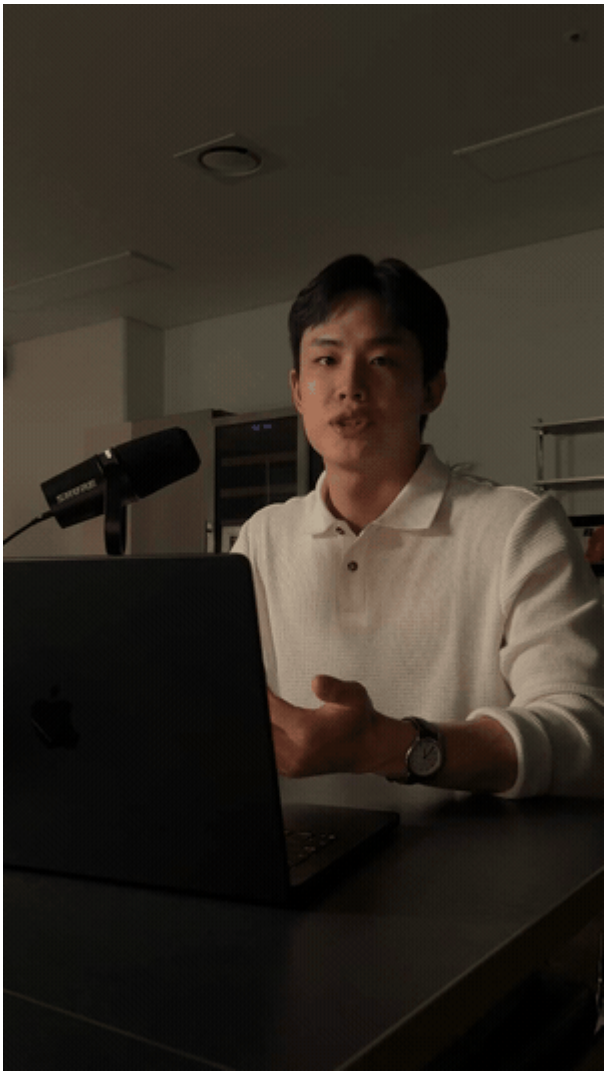
Make it better: a real screenshot looks much better than a mocked-up editor. Use the real thing whenever you can.

10. Transitions



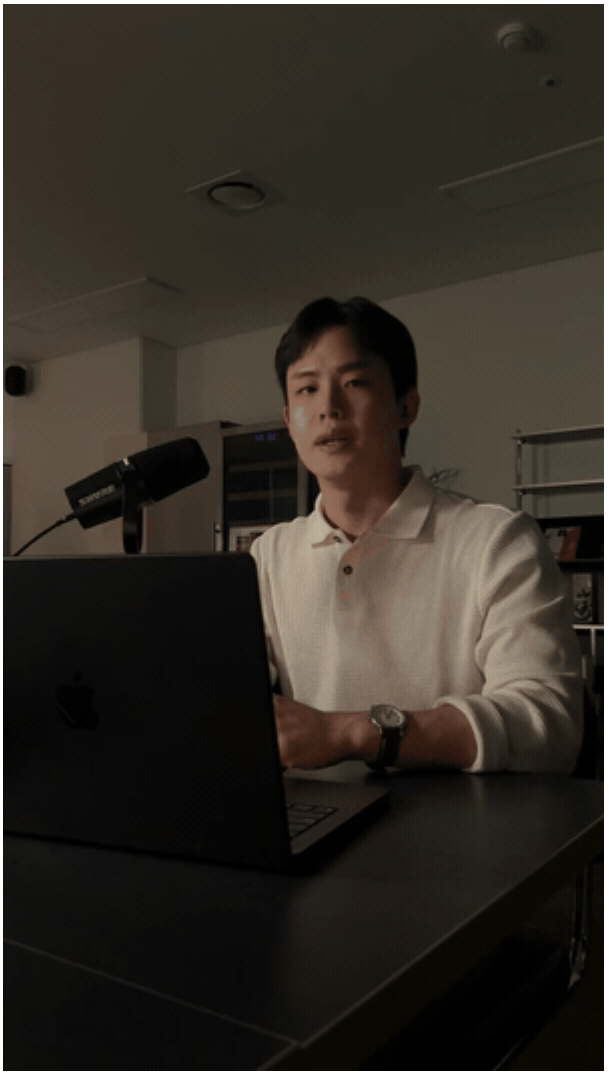
```
On the word "this", shrink my shot into a picture of itself, 3 levels deep, landing ab
ove my head. Hold, then push through it into the next shot.
```

Make it better: these zooms are a bit much. I'd go with a whip pan instead:



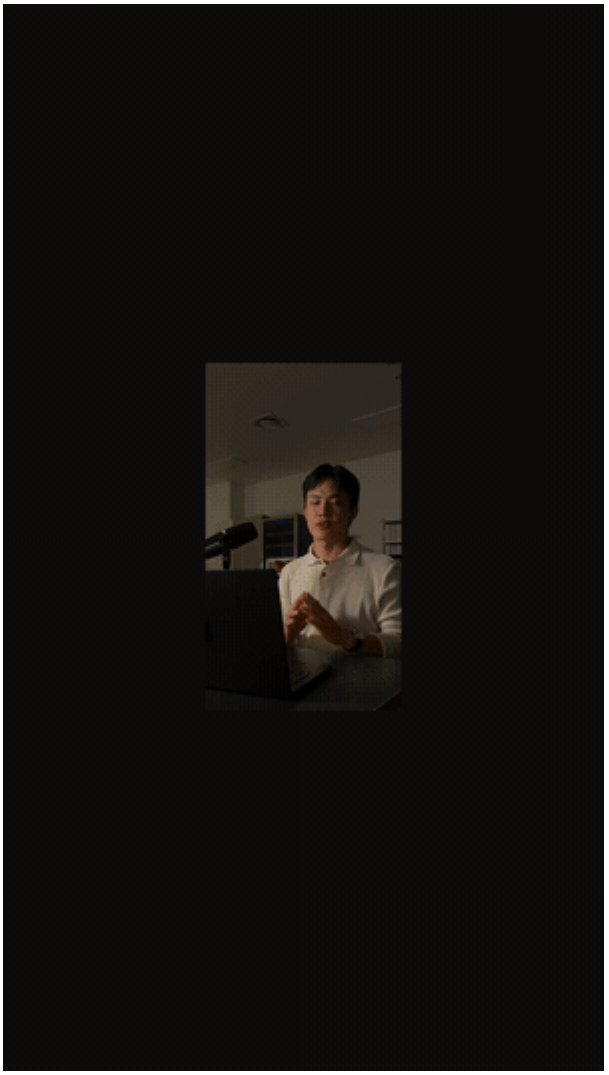
```
Whip-pan between these two shots. In the last 6 frames of the first shot, slide it lef
t by 8% of the frame width while blurring it up to 50 px (ease-in). Cut. The next shot
starts 8% to the right, fully blurred, and settles into place over 6 frames (ease-out
cubic). It should feel like one fast camera move.
```

11. Moody grade

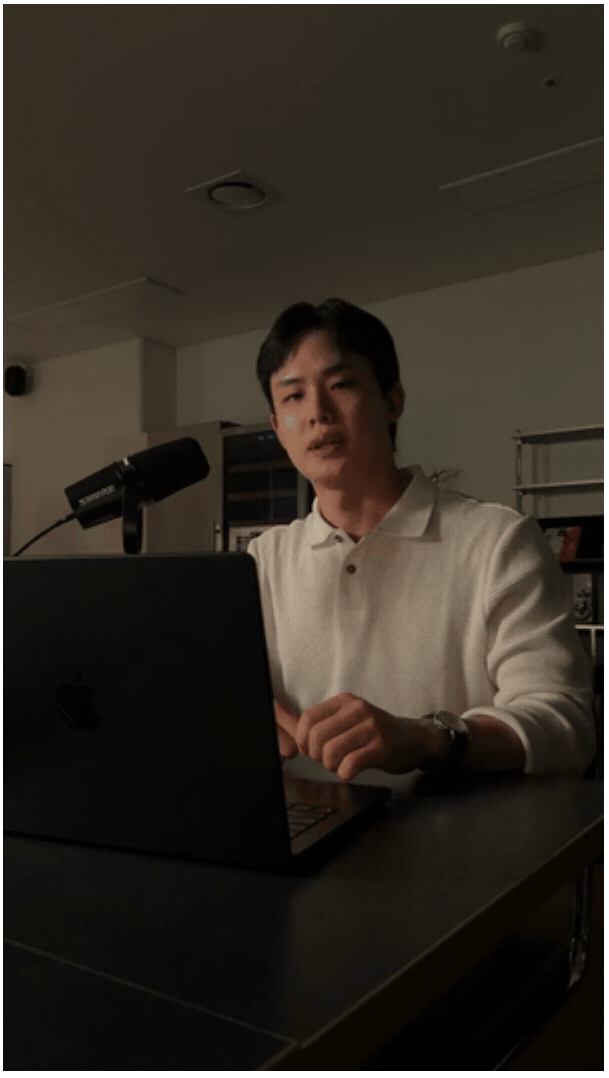


```
Grade my clip with FFmpeg: curves to pull the highlights down and lift the blacks, sat
uration down 15%, then a soft vignette.
Above my head, show a grading panel like Lightroom's (Tone Curve, Basic, Effects) and
move each control as I say it, with the shot regrading live.
```

12. Wall of reels



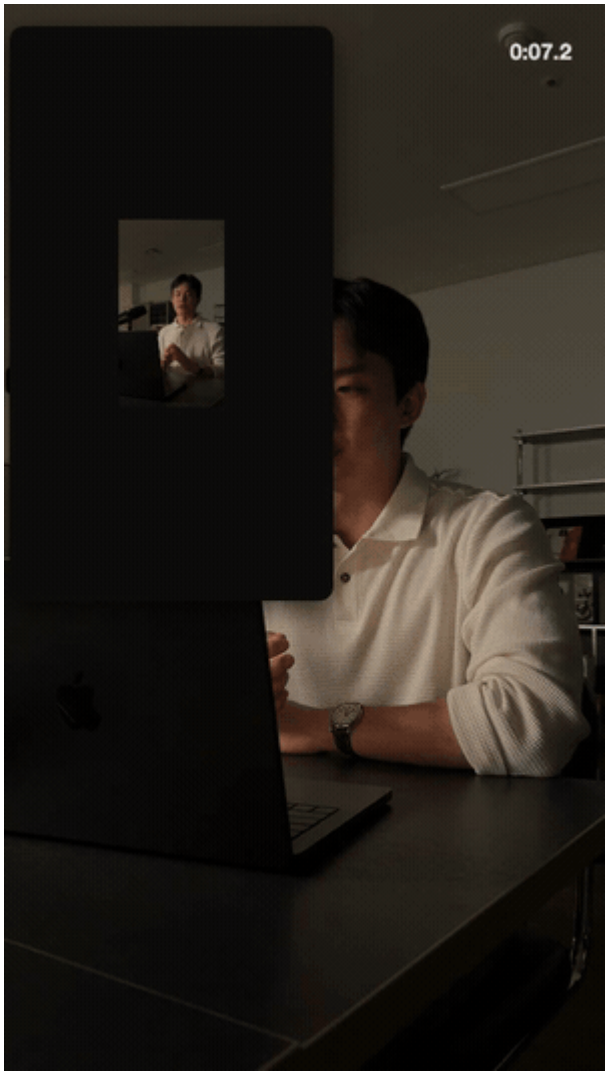
```
Shrink my shot into the centre of a 3x3 grid and fill the other 8 tiles with these ree
ls, popping in one per frame.
```



To grab the reels, use yt-dlp. It's free and downloads videos from Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, pretty much anywhere.

```
Download these reels with yt-dlp: [paste links]
```

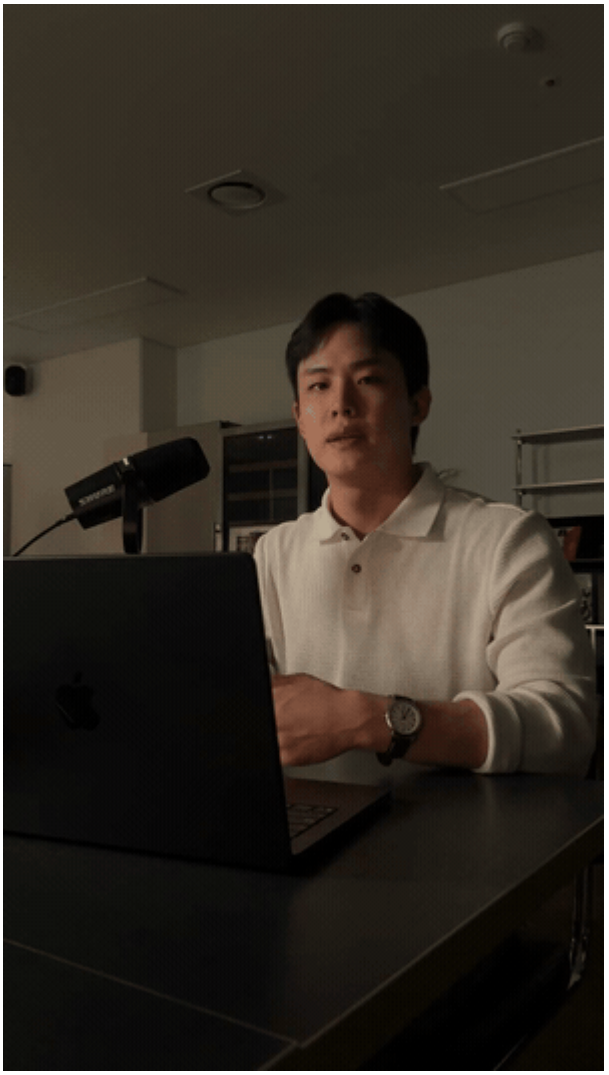
13. Pause and explain



The format of the whole video: the clip plays in a window, freezes on a click with the timecode holding, then shrinks to the side while I explain.

```
Play this clip in a window in the top left (54% of the frame wide). On a mouse-click s
ound, freeze it and stop the timecode in the corner. 10 frames later, shrink the windo
w to the left side (24% wide, rounded corners) over 12 frames (ease-out cubic) while I
talk. When I'm done, grow it back and let it play.
```

14. Jump cuts



```
Cut every pause longer than 0.22 s, never inside a word. Alternate normal and tight fr
aming (1.15x) on every cut. No zooms or transitions.
```